Returna — Regulatory Tailwinds

February 2026

The Compliance Wave Hitting Enterprise IT

2026 marks a turning point. A convergence of EU and US regulations is forcing enterprises to document, track, and report on IT asset end-of-life. This isn't optional sustainability — it's compliance.

Returna is positioned as **infrastructure for this new reality**.

Key Regulations Driving Demand

🇪🇺 EU Regulations (Active 2024-2027)

Regulation	Effective	Impact on Enterprise IT
CSRD	2024-2026	Mandatory ESG reporting incl. circular economy metrics
NIS2	Oct 2024	Supply chain security, audit trails for IT assets
ESPR	Jan 2025	Ecodesign requirements, ban on destroying unsold electronics
Digital Product Passport	2026-27	Lifecycle data required for electronics
Right to Repair	July 2026	Spare parts & documentation mandated
WEEE (strengthened)	Ongoing	Extended producer responsibility

🇺🇸 US Regulations

Regulation	Effective	Impact
FTC Safeguards Rule (GLBA)	Updated 2024	Financial institutions: secure disposal of customer data
HIPAA	Active	Healthcare data: documented destruction required
CCPA/CPRA	2023+	California: consumer rights incl. deletion
SEC Climate Disclosure	Pending	Scope 3 includes IT asset lifecycle

🔒 Data Security (Global)

Standard	Scope	Requirement
GDPR Art. 17	EU + global	Documented data erasure
NIST 800-88	US Federal	Data sanitization standard

Why This Matters Now

The Problem Enterprises Face

1. **CSRD requires reporting** on circular economy practices — but most enterprises don't track device end-of-life
2. **GDPR mandates documented erasure** — 4% of global revenue at risk for non-compliance
3. **ESPR bans destruction** of functional electronics — enterprises need certified refurb/resale channels
4. **Digital Product Passports** require lifecycle data — enterprises lack the infrastructure

The Gap in the Market

- **250M+ corporate devices** leave company control annually
- No global platform standardizes end-of-life workflow
- Enterprises rely on fragmented, local ITAD vendors
- Audit trails are manual, incomplete, or non-existent

Returna's Position

What We Are

Global orchestration platform for IT asset end-of-life

Enterprise → Returna → Return Hubs (ITAD contractors) → Processing → Disposition

Why We Win

Compliance Need	Returna Delivers
CSRD reporting	Automated ESG metrics per device
GDPR erasure proof	Certified data destruction with audit trail
NIS2 supply chain	Audit trails, chain-of-custody, certified partners
ESPR circularity	Refurb-first routing, no unnecessary destruction
DPP readiness	Full lifecycle data capture
Global coverage	Single platform, certified local execution

Our Moat

1. **Network effect** — More Return Hubs = better coverage = more enterprise demand
2. **Data layer** — We own the lifecycle data enterprises need for compliance
3. **Neutrality** — Platform, not processor — we route to best-fit local partners
4. **First mover** — Building the network now, before compliance deadlines hit

Market Timing

Year	Intensity	Milestones
2024		CSRD Phase 1, California R2R
2025		CSRD Phase 2, ESPR active, GDPR up
→ 2026		Right to Repair, DPP pilots — **WE ARE HERE**
2027		Full DPP rollout for electronics
2028+		Mature compliance landscape

Building infrastructure before the compliance wave hits fully in 2027

Competitive Landscape

Player	Model	Limitation
Large ITADs	Own processing	Conflict of interest, limited geography
Local ITADs	Regional	No scale, no enterprise contracts
ITAM software	Software only	No execution capability
Returna	Platform + Network	Neutral, global, compliant

Traction

- **First enterprise customer:** Global Business Travel (20K employees, March 2026 go-live)
- **Return Hub network:** Building European coverage (Nordics, UK, DACH, Western EU)
- **Platform:** Live, proven at Scandic IT (co-founder's ITAD operation)

Key Takeaways

1. **Regulatory tailwinds are real** — CSRD, ESPR, NIS2, DPP, GDPR create compliance pressure now
2. **Enterprises need infrastructure** — not just vendors, but auditable platforms
3. **Timing is optimal** — build the network before 2027 compliance deadlines
4. **Returna is uniquely positioned** — neutral platform with execution capability

"Compliance. Sustainability. Value. One platform."